

Viksit Bharat 2047

Research Program

Building the Developmental Feedback Architecture that Viksit Bharat 2047 Demands

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The Stakes

India is attempting the most ambitious development transition in modern history.

\$30–40T

Target economy
by 2047

1.4B

People whose
lives depend on it

20 years

Of peak demographic
dividend remaining

Every year of institutional drift compounds the cost. The demographic window does not wait.

The central question: is India creating enough quality jobs to make that transformation real for 1.4 billion people?

The next step for India: moving from innovation aspirations to real outcomes for 1.4 billion people.

The Book — Four Years in the Making

August 15, 2047

India's Centennial Promise

This program operationalizes the diagnosis and institutional design this book proposes.

The Question

Why is India — growing at 8% annually — not creating enough quality jobs for 1.4 billion people? And what would the institutional architecture to change that actually look like?

The Research

Four years visiting nearly 100 colleges across India. Three months of comparative fieldwork across India, South Korea, and China. Named conversations with former KDI President, CEIBS economists, IIT-H faculty, ARCI scientists, and industry leaders.

The Argument

The gap between Viksit Bharat as aspiration and Viksit Bharat as lived experience is not a capability gap. It is a discipline gap. Strengthen the roots. The fruit will follow.

Manuscript substantially complete | Vasu Eda | Author of Get Job Ready (Penguin Random House)

The Institutional Learning Gap

India has vision. India has funding. What India lacks is a feedback and learning architecture.

Strong on ambition, weaker on feedback and learning

Schemes are launched with ambition, rarely evaluated honestly, quietly replaced. The pattern repeats.

Measures inputs, not outcomes

Education years $\neq$ employment. R&D spend $\neq$ innovation. Announcements $\neq$ capability. The feedback loop is broken.

Invisible failure, no feedback

Without feedback loops that surface failure, institutions optimise for process rather than outcomes. Inaction carries no visible cost until it compounds.

Talent misallocated at scale

Lakhs compete for years for $\sim$ 1,000 UPSC positions. Millions of peak productive years redirected away from innovation.

The Opportunity

If India Succeeds

- ✓ Strongest development transition in modern history
- ✓ 1.4B people lifted through productive, dignified work
- ✓ A global model for institutional learning
- ✓ Viksit Bharat 2047 — a genuine \$30–40T economy

If India Stagnates

- Demographic dividend dissipates unrealised
- Institutional weaknesses compound for decades
- Growth without lived outcomes
- 2047 becomes another aspirational date that passed

The difference is not capability. It is institutional feedback, measurement, and accountability.

The Initiative

Building on the diagnosis and institutional design proposed in the author's forthcoming book, the program operationalizes that design through four interconnected research tracks — adaptive governance, talent scaling, industrial capability, and lived development outcomes.

COORDINATING LAYER — Cross-track synthesis, state engagement, and programme coherence

01

Adaptive
Governance

02

Talent
Scaling

03

Industrial
Capability

04

Lived Development
Outcomes

STRATEGIC POLICY PARTNER — Translating research into policy dialogue, government engagement, and national adoption

Institutions → Talent → Industry → Lived Outcomes | Continuous Feedback & Learning Loop

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The Viksit Bharat Development Tree



The quality of the fruit ultimately depends on the health of the roots.

Quality jobs is the mother of all development outcomes. Everything else follows from it.

From Research to Impact

Phase 1: Build

Years 1–2

- Field-grounded research across tracks
- Two pilot states selected — engaging state partners as co-designers
- Coordinating layer established to connect tracks and manage state engagement
- Policy roundtables & government engagement
- Institutional Effectiveness Framework
- Lived Development Outcomes Framework

Phase 2: Embed & Drive

Years 3–5

- Pilot implementation in state governments
- Active policy proposals & dialogue
- Founding Director institutionally embedded
- Anchor institutions develop own funding

Phase 3: Scale

Year 5+

- Governments fund pilots & implementation
- National institutions own tracks
- Endowed chairs, centers, alumni funding
- Program handed to institutions it serves

From the Field

Aboard the Hisar–Tirupati Special in Warangal — the train already seven hours delayed — a soldier who had boarded in Hisar sat next to me for 12 hours, carrying candies for his children. He was not waiting for announcements. He was waiting for a system that works.



Job Quality Gap

A machine learning graduate, parents sacrificed to fund her education. Graduation approaching. No job offers. No pathway from credential to productive work.



Economic Security Gap

A working family in Hyderabad — stable combined income. Child falls sick. The choice: personal loan at 2% monthly interest, or delay treatment.



Urban Livability Gap

Warangal — a city of over one million. Intermittent water supply. Minimal sewage treatment. Annual flooding. Basic services unreliable a decade after rapid growth.



Economic Friction Gap

A startup founder built EVs for street vendors — a real market need. Government procurement could be the first customer. The process stretches indefinitely.

These aren't isolated stories. They're patterns — and exactly what a developmental feedback architecture is designed to detect, measure, and change.

“Quality jobs is the mother of all development outcomes.” — Dr. E. Revathi, Centre for Economic and Social Studies, Hyderabad

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Traction to Date



Published

Three articles in The Print — KDI vs NITI Aayog, India's AI Mission, and why India's sovereign AI aspirations hinge on enterprise adoption of Sarvam — generating engagement from senior policy voices



Government Access

Meetings with EAC-PM member Dr. Shamika Ravi and senior NITI Aayog officials



Academic Conversations

BITS Pilani has signed a Letter of Intent to anchor Track 2. Active discussions continue with IIT Hyderabad, Takshashila, CESS, and Azim Premji University.



Institutional Host

A leading policy think tank has expressed strong interest in serving as the program's institutional secretariat.



Field Research

Dr. Dongchul Cho (former KDI President), Dr. Xiaohuan Lan (CEIBS, How China Works), Dr. Kyunghoon Kim (KIEP), Prof. B.S. Murty (IIT-H), Dr. Vijay Reddy (ARCI), Ashok Atluri, Mohandas Pai

Beyond Research — A Movement Every Indian Can Own

The program seeds something larger than research. August 15, 2047 is not just a deadline — it is a civic moment.

Research Fellowships

Next-generation policy thinkers embedded at IIT-H, BITS, Azim Premji University — the generation that will live and work in 2047.

Sponsored Chairs

Permanent institutional homes for each research track. Naming opportunities for funders. Enduring presence beyond the program's founding phase.

Student Chapters

IITs, BITS, IIMs — faculty-anchored chapters producing working papers and hosting local events. A pipeline into the fellowship program.

Annual August 15 Scorecard

Every Independence Day, an honest evidence-based assessment of India's progress toward 2047. The program's signature public contribution.

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A civic identity every Indian can embrace — students, diaspora, corporates, citizens. Research is the backbone. The movement is the face.

Diaspora Bridge

A platform for the Indian diaspora to contribute meaningfully to 2047 — not just financially, but intellectually and institutionally.

What Success Looks Like

Measurable milestones across a five-year horizon — not publications, but adoption and systemic change.

By End of Year 2

- 6 to 8 working papers and diagnostic reports published
- Institutional Effectiveness Framework prototype completed
- Lived Development Outcomes Framework validated
- Synthesis book published and launched

By End of Year 4

- IEF piloted in 2 to 3 state governments
- Founding Director institutionally embedded in think tank or foundation
- Anchor institutions developing own funding streams
- Policy proposals in active government dialogue

By 2030

- National institutions taking ownership of tracks
- Scorecard metrics cited in NITI Aayog Viksit Bharat monitoring
- Government bodies funding pilots and scale implementation
- Program frameworks embedded in India development planning

Phase 1 funders seed an ecosystem — anchor institutions, government bodies, and think tanks progressively take ownership of funding and implementation in Phases 2 and 3.

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Potential Institutional Ecosystem

The program operates through four distinct engagement layers — each playing a specific role in building, connecting, and sustaining India's institutional capability research ecosystem.

Coordinating Layer

A dedicated coordination function connecting the four research tracks, managing state engagement, and synthesising cross-track learning.

Strategic Policy Partner

A leading policy think tank serving as the strategic policy interface — connecting research outputs to government, convening dialogue, and driving policy adoption.

Track Anchors

Leading universities and research institutions anchoring each of the four research tracks — bringing academic rigor, research capacity, and institutional credibility.

State Partners

Two pilot states engaged as co-designers from Phase 1 — representing different governance contexts and geographies — providing the ground-level testing environment for cross-track research.

Strategic Ecosystem Partners

Senior policy advisors, industry leaders, diaspora networks, and ecosystem organisations providing high-level guidance, convening power, and network access.

Advisory & Diaspora Network

International comparative experts, senior Indian policy voices, and diaspora leaders providing intellectual guidance and global perspective.

On August 15, 2047, India turns 100.

The question is not whether we celebrate.

The question is what we will have built.

Research that holds the mirror.

Fellowships that build the next generation.

A civic moment every Indian can own.

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